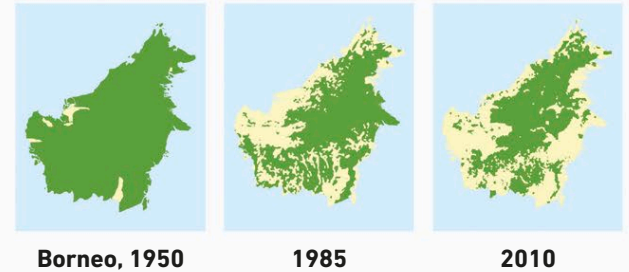


Taiga

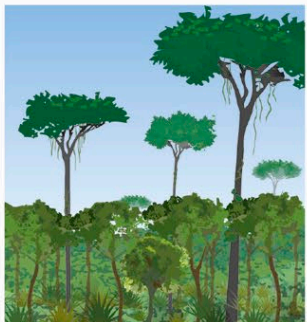
This vast belt of boreal forest stretches right across northern Europe and Asia. In the east, it is wilderness, but much in the west is working forest, managed for lumber and paper production.

Disappearing forests

With the world's population growing, demand for lumber and land for farming and towns has increased the rate of forest clearance. Here you can see the decline in Borneo's forests from 1950 to 2010.



**AT CURRENT
RATES OF LOGGING,
IN 100 YEARS WE
WILL NO LONGER HAVE
ANY RAINFORESTS**

**Tropical rainforest**

As many as 300 tree species per 2.5 acres (hectare). Often rich in forest-floor plants.

**Boreal forest**

Hardy conifers, such as larch, spruce, fir, and pine. Mosses dominate the forest floor.

Japan

Japan retains a lot of its original woodland and is the most thickly forested industrialized country.

Borneo

Home of most of the world's orangutans, Borneo's rainforest has declined by more than 50 percent since the mid-20th century (see above).

New Guinea

Two-thirds of New Guinea is largely unspoiled rainforest, with many unique species. It is at risk from logging, mining, and agriculture.

Australia

About 38 percent of Australia's forests have been lost since European settlers arrived around 200 years ago.

New Zealand

The remote southwest of New Zealand is home to unique temperate rainforests full of lush tree ferns.